



presents

Weaving Flowers, Wandering Stains, and Floating Silks

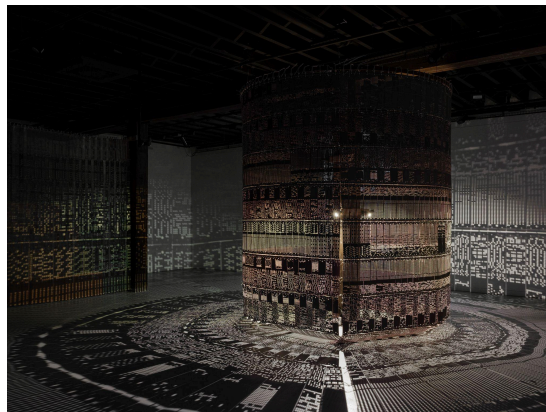
A solo exhibition by Archana Hande

Curated by Tasneem Zakaria Mehta

Preview: Friday, 09 January 2026, 6:00 PM

On view from 10 Jan to 1 March 2026 | 10 am – 5:30 pm

Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Museum, Mumbai



Weaving Lights, Archana Hande, Artspace Sydney, 2025. Photo credit: Hamish McIntosh.

The Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Museum is delighted to present the exhibition, 'Weaving Flowers, Wandering Stains, and Floating Silks' by artist Archana Hande, an alumnus of Shantiniketan and MSU Baroda. Her work explores the colonial manipulation of identity and culture through labour policies and practices. She presents complex textile histories that have been the foundation of cities like Bombay (now Mumbai), Bangalore (now Bengaluru), Mangalore, Madras (now Chennai), Calcutta (now Kolkata), Kochi and others, to comment on civilizational changes and aspirations; the nuances that produce power relationships; the profound labour of the artisan/craftsman that remains unacknowledged; the loss of legacy through migration and loss of habitat and livelihood; and the intimate experience of desire and memory

that are secrets woven into textiles. She has spent time deeply researching Mumbai's textile industries and labour movements and her work draws on this to build powerful visual narratives.

Hande employs the medium of textile production – jacquard punching sheets, block prints that she incises herself, as both an epistemological tool and a formal homage to the craftspeople and labourers who remain invisible and unacknowledged, recalling the craftspeople who made the objects in the Museum. Like the early anthropologists and archivists she has collected their stories through which she frames her own narratives.

The canvas is the city where migrants including textile workers who have been displaced by industrialisation come in search of jobs. Their aspirations and desires are woven into the fabrics that adorn the world. Hande's work further explores notions of beauty, and the insidious seduction of advertising, that preys on concepts of identity and community.

The transformation of the textile industry from a legacy based village industry to mass produced cloth made in mills, became the basis on which the wealth and growth of many cities across India and the world were built. Ironically it mirrors the technological transformation taking place today. Though the work narrates the past it also enquires into the future providing a visual template for us to reflect on our responses to our environment and our aspirations.

The exhibition is supported by Chemould Prescott Road.
Additional support provided by the Max Muller Bhavan, Mumbai.

About the Artist

Archana Hande holds a B.F.A & M.F.A in print making, from Visva-Bharati, Santiniketan, (1986-1991) and M.S University, Baroda, India (1991-1993). She has been awarded the Charles Wallace India Trust Arts Awards, a Residency at the Glasgow School of Arts in the year 2000, a Research Residency, Pro Helvetia, Switzerland 2010. Research project: Spaced 2: future recall with Spaced (Perth) and Asialink (Melbourne) reciprocal exchange program, Western Australia; 2014-16. She had many solo shows, few major once are: "Weaving Light: Bangalore, 2024; 'I am a Landscape Painter 2015': Bombay; 'The Golden Feral Trail': Perth and Laverton, WA, Australia 2014; 'All is Fair in Magic White': Delhi & Rome 2010; 'www.arrangeurownmarriage.com': Bombay, China, Finland, Sweden 2008- 2012; 'Relics of Grey': Bombay 2007

She has participated in many international and national group shows few of which are: *DM_Always@Already* (digital materialities in the 21st century), Artspace Sydney 2025; Anka Banka, Bengal Biennale, 2024-25; In Our Veins Flow Ink and Fire,

Kochi-Muziris Biennale 5, 2022-23; Thinking Historically in the Present, Sharjah Biennial 15, 2023; This Too, is a Map, 12th Seoul Mediacity Biennale, 2023; Sculpture Park Jaipur 2018-19; "Social Fabric", INIVA, UK, Sweden, Germany, India; "Shadow Lines", Biennale Jogja XI Jakarta; 'So Close Yet So Far Away', Incheon Women Artists' Biennale; 'SAMTIDIGT', (concurrent), Sweden, Finland; 'Farewell to Post-Colonialism', The 3rd Guangzhou Triennial; The Edge of Desire: Recent art in India, Australia, New York, Mexico city, Monterrey; 'Art Circus' Yokohama Triennial, Japan.

Her other projects are: Co-Curated 'Project Cinema City' 2012, Bombay, Delhi, Bangalore, Pune, Berlin. Curated Students Biennale 4th edition 2020-2021: States of Disarray: Practice as Restitution. Researched, photographed and designed the book: "Multiplicities" urban cultures of the Mumbai Metropolitan Region. Published in 2021 by The MMR-HCS, Mumbai.

About the Curator

Tasneem Zakaria Mehta, Managing Trustee and Director of the Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Museum, is an art historian, curator, designer, conservationist, and cultural activist. She is the former Vice Chairman and Mumbai Convenor of INTACH (Indian National Trust for Art and Cultural Heritage). She has successfully pioneered the revival and restoration of several cultural sites in Mumbai, most notably leading the restoration of the Museum, which received UNESCO's 2005 Asia Pacific Award of Excellence for Cultural Restoration.

She has served on several Indian museum boards and is on the Modern and Contemporary Art Councils at The Museum of Modern Art (MoMA), and The Metropolitan Museum of Art, New York, and is a member of Asia Society India Centre's Advisory Council for Arts and Culture. She was the past Chair of the CII National Committee on Art and Culture, has curated over 25 exhibitions of contemporary and historical art at the Museum, and has curated an exhibition of Indian Contemporary Art, and invited to speak at the World Economic Forum in Davos. She is a founding trustee of the Kochi Muziris biennale.

She has written numerous articles and books on art and culture. Her most recent publication, Mumbai: A City Through Objects – 101 Stories from the Dr Bhau Daji Lad Museum (Harper Design, 2022), which has won several awards, including Art Book of the Year. She has won numerous awards and was selected by Harvard University for their Star Women programme.

About Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Museum

The Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Museum is Mumbai's first museum, established in 1857, and is the erstwhile Victoria and Albert Museum, Bombay. The Museum building and

collections underwent a comprehensive restoration, spearheaded by Tasneem Zakaria Mehta as Convenor of the Mumbai Chapter of the Indian National Trust for Art and Cultural Heritage (INTACH). It was supported by the Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai and the Jamnalal Bajaj Foundation. It opened to the public in 2008, and has pioneered contemporary art and design which is presented in the extraordinary 19th-century building, one of the finest in India, in an attempt to rethink the cannon and challenge colonial and enlightenment precepts.

The Museum was built to showcase the city's contemporary art and craftsmanship of the 19th and early 20th centuries through a rare collection of fine and decorative arts of India.

The Museum's robust exhibition and outreach programme invites artists to engage with these collections and archives and interrogate its founding principles. Over 85 exhibitions have been presented, which include collaborations with both local and international institutions and organisations. Past exhibitions have showcased contemporary creative practices in design, crafts and textiles, architecture, urbanism, and film and video art.

The exhibition is on view at:

Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Museum, Veermata Jijabai Bhosale Botanical Udyan and Zoo (Rani Bagh), 91-A, Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Road, Byculla (E), Mumbai – 400027

Timings: 10 am to 5:30 pm | Closed all Wednesdays and certain public holidays

Museum entry tickets applicable

For more information about the Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Mumbai City Museum, please visit www.bdlmuseum.org

Instagram: <https://www.instagram.com/bdlmuseum/>

Facebook: www.facebook.com/BDLMuseum

Contact: +91 22 23741234 / +91 8097530719

For press enquiries, please contact:

Maithilee Gotpagar (Curatorial Assistant, BDL Museum):

mgotpagar@bdlmuseum.org / enquiry@bdlmuseum.org